Chapter 9

Deploy to Physical Devices with TestFlight and Play Testing

By now, you have a solid understanding of how to build iOS and Android apps powered by Hotwire Native. You can add a native tab bar, render views with SwiftUI and Jetpack Compose, and progressively enhance screens with bridge components. But, if you build an app and never deploy it…is it really an app? And if you don't deploy your app, there's no way to show off your hard work to your friends and colleagues!

Testing on a *real* device is a prerequisite for deployment. This chapter walks you through getting your apps on real, physical devices. You'll deploy the iOS app with TestFlight, a first-party app from Apple that lets folks download apps for beta testing before they arrive in the App Store. You'll then use Google Play Testing to get the Android app off of the emulator and into your hands for beta testing.

For iOS, you'll work through these steps:

1. Set up your app in App Store Connect.
2. Archive a build in Xcode.
3. Download the app to your device via TestFlight.

Let's get started.